

[Lesson 42](#): Continuing Revelation to Latter-day Prophets (See L42 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To show us that the Lord continues to guide the Church through revelation to latter-day prophets, seers, and revelators.

†1. President Harold B. Lee

†2. President Spencer W. Kimball

[Pictures of our Church Presidents](#)

1. Church correlation

• Read about Church correlation in *Our Heritage*. Begin with the last paragraph on page 117 and read all of page 118.

†3. Church correlation †4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

1. **Importance of the family:** “Monday evenings are reserved for family home evening throughout the Church and should be kept free from Church meetings and activities.” (*Lesson Manual*)

How has family home evening influenced your life?

What have you done to make family home evenings successful? †5. The Family

Why is it important to understand that Church auxiliaries, programs, and activities exist to support the family?

2. **Operation of Church auxiliaries:** †6. Church Auxiliaries

Why is it important to unify and coordinate the efforts of the auxiliary organizations in the ward?

3. **Preparation of Church publications:** †7. Church Publications

How can lessons taught at church support parents’ efforts to teach their children at home?

4. **Home Teaching:**

• Read [D&C 20:53–55](#). Home “visits by priesthood holders have been part of the Church since the time of the Prophet Joseph Smith. As part of the correlation effort, these visits were reemphasized in the 1960s and called home teaching. Home teaching continues to be a vital responsibility of teachers, priests, and Melchizedek Priesthood holders.” (*LM*)

What are the purposes of home teaching?

What experiences have shown you the importance of home teaching?

• Read D&C 132:8. “Behold, mine house is a house of order, saith the Lord God, and not a house of confusion.”

What can we do individually and in our Church callings to apply the principles of Church correlation?

2. Revelation extending the blessings of the priesthood to every worthy male member of the Church

In “June 1978, President Spencer W. Kimball announced a revelation that extended the blessings of the priesthood to every worthy male member of the Church.”

• Read *Our Heritage*, [pages 125–27](#). Read [Official Declaration 2](#). Read *Our Heritage*, [page 126](#).

What can we learn from the process President Kimball went through before receiving this revelation?

†8. Elder Bruce R. McConkie

3. Publication of new Latter-day Saint editions of the scriptures

†9. Latter-day Saint editions of scripture

• Read [Ezekiel 37:15–19](#).

How do the new editions of the scriptures help the Bible and Book of Mormon become “one in [your] hand”?

†10. Elder Boyd K. Packer †11. President Gordon B. Hinckley

4. Additional Quorums of the Seventy

• Read [D&C 107:25, 34](#). What are the responsibilities of the Seventy? †12. The Seventy

• Read [D&C 107:93–97](#). How does creation of additional Quorums of the Seventy comply with this revelation?

How do you think the calling of Area Authority Seventies will help the Church as it grows?

†13. President Gordon B. Hinckley †14. President Ezra Taft Benson

Next Week: L43: “Take upon You My Whole Armor”; See L43 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. **President Harold B. Lee:** “Elder John A. Widtsoe of the Council of the Twelve once told of a discussion he had with a group of stake officers. In the course of the discussion someone said to him, ‘Brother Widtsoe, how long has it been since the Church received a revelation?’ Brother Widtsoe rubbed his chin thoughtfully and said in reply, ‘Oh, probably since last Thursday’” (Stand Ye in Holy Places [1974], 132–33).

†2. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “We testify to the world that revelation continues and that the vaults and files of the Church contain these revelations which come month to month and day to day. We testify also that there is, since 1830 when The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints was organized, and will continue to be, so long as time shall last, a prophet, recognized of God and his people, who will continue to interpret the mind and will of the Lord. ...

“Expecting the spectacular, one may not be fully alerted to the constant flow of revealed communication. I say, in the deepest of humility, but also by the power and force of a burning testimony in my soul, that from the prophet of the Restoration to the prophet of our own year, the communication line is unbroken, the authority is continuous, a light, brilliant and penetrating, continues to shine. The sound of the voice of the Lord is a continuous melody and a thunderous appeal. For nearly a century and a half there has been no interruption” (“[Revelation: The Word of the Lord to His Prophets](#),” Ensign, May 1977, 78).

†3. **Church correlation includes:**

- a. Maintaining purity of doctrine.
- b. Emphasizing importance of family and home.
- c. Placing all Church work under priesthood direction.
- d. Establishing proper relationships among organizations of the Church.
- e. Achieving unity and order in the Church.
- f. Ensuring simplicity of Church programs and materials.

†4. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie** said that correlation is a process “in which we take all the programs of the Church, bring them to one focal point, wrap them in one package, operate them as one program, involve all members of the Church in the operation—and do it all under priesthood direction” (*Let Every Man Learn His Duty* [pamphlet, 1976], 2). (*Lesson Manual*)

†5. **The Family:** “The most important place for gospel teaching and leadership is in the family and the home (see Mosiah 4:14-15; D&C 68:25-28). ... Quorums, auxiliaries, programs, and activities in the Church should strengthen and support the family. They should enhance gospel-centered family activities, not compete with them.” (*Church Handbook of Instructions* See

Book 2: Priesthood and Auxiliary Leaders [1998], 299) (*Lesson Manual*)

“The correlation effort also emphasizes that Church programs and activities should not make unnecessary demands on the effort, time, or other resources of Church members.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†6. **Church Auxiliaries:** “For many years these organizations were somewhat independent. At the general Church level, some had their own magazines, funding, and conferences. As they grew, they became increasingly complex and often had unnecessary duplication in their programs and materials.

“Through the process of correlation, such complexity and duplication have been reduced. Through correlation, there has also been an emphasis on auxiliary organizations functioning under the direction of priesthood leaders. For example, in a ward these organizations all function under the direction of the bishopric.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†7. **Church Publications:** “Church publications, such as lesson manuals and Church magazines, are produced to help members learn and live the gospel of Jesus Christ. The correlation process helps ensure that these materials are scripture-based, doctrinally accurate, and appropriate for the intended audience. All Church publications are planned, prepared, reviewed, and implemented under the direction of the First Presidency and Quorum of the Twelve.

“One result of correlation in Church publications is that adult and youth Gospel Doctrine classes and most Primary classes study the same book of scripture during the year. This can encourage and facilitate discussion of the scriptures in the home.” (*LM*)

Recommended reading:

1. Boyd K. Packer, “[The Father and the Family](#),” *Ensign*, May 1994, 19-20.
2. Richard Neitzel Holzapfel, “[The Incomparable Blessings of the Priesthood](#),” *Ensign*, Oct. 1997, 40. (Find and read the story of Billy Johnson.)
3. Elder Boyd K. Packer, “[Scriptures](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1982, 53.
4. Scot Facer Proctor, “[Lesson 42: Continuing Revelation to Latter-day Prophets](#),” Meridian Magazine.

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†8. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie** described the revelation regarding extension of the priesthood to all worthy males: “It was during this prayer that the revelation came. The Spirit of the Lord rested mightily upon us all; we felt something akin to what happened on the day of Pentecost and at the dedication of the Kirtland Temple. From the midst of eternity, the voice of God, conveyed by the power of the Spirit, spoke to his prophet ... And we all heard the same voice, received the same message, and became personal witnesses that the word was received was the mind and will and voice of the Lord.” (quoted in *The Church in the Twentieth Century*, 391)

†9. **Latter-day Saint editions of scripture:** In “1979, after years of careful work under the direction of the First Presidency and the Quorum of the Twelve, the Church published a Latter-day Saint edition of the Bible. This edition of the Bible has the same text as the King James Version, but it includes special study aids, such as the Topical Guide, the Bible Dictionary, and footnotes referring to passages in other books of scripture and to excerpts from Joseph Smith’s translation of the Bible.” (*LM*)

“In 1981, the Church published a new edition of the triple combination (the Book of Mormon, Doctrine and Covenants, and Pearl of Great Price in a single volume), with expanded footnotes and index entries.” (*LM*)

†10. **Elder Boyd K. Packer:** “With the passing of years, these scriptures will produce successive generations of faithful Christians who know the Lord Jesus Christ and are disposed to obey His will. ... The revelations will be opened to them as to no other [generation] in the history of the world. Into their hands now are placed the sticks of Joseph and of Judah. They will develop a gospel scholarship beyond that which their forebears could achieve. They will have the testimony that Jesus is the Christ and be competent to proclaim Him and to defend Him” (“[Scriptures](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1982, 53).

†11. **President Gordon B. Hinckley** made an observation that shows that Elder Packer’s words are being fulfilled: “I look back to my own youth. Neither young men nor young women were doing much scripture reading at that time. What a marvelous change has been wrought. A new generation is arising who are familiar with the word of the Lord” (“[We Have a Work to Do](#),” *Ensign*, May 1995, 87).

†12. **The Seventy:** For “many years there were only seven General Authorities of the Church who served as Seventies. They made up the First Council of the Seventy. In 1975, others were called; they served in the First Quorum of the Seventy. Further expansion came in 1989, when a Second Quorum of the Seventy was added.

“In April 1995, President Gordon B. Hinckley announced the calling of new local officers, called Area Authorities, who would serve for a period of about six years. (“[This Work Is Concerned with People](#),” *Ensign*, May 1995, 52.)

“In 1997, President Hinckley announced that Area Authorities would be ordained Seventies and would form the Third, Fourth, and Fifth Quorums of the Seventy. Unlike Seventies who serve as General Authorities, Area Authority Seventies serve in the areas in which they live and continue in their present employment.” (“[May We Be Faithful and True](#),” *Ensign*, May 1997, 5–6.)

†13. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “With these respective quorums in place, we have established a pattern under which the Church may grow to any size with an organization of Area Presidencies and Area Authority Seventies, chosen and working across the world according to need. Now, the Lord is watching over His kingdom. He is inspiring its leadership to care for its ever growing membership” (“[May We Be Faithful and True](#),” *Ensign*, May 1997, 6).

†14. **President Ezra Taft Benson:** “God’s revelations to Adam did not instruct Noah how to build the ark. Noah needed his own revelation. Therefore, the most important prophet, so far as you and I are concerned, is the one living in our day and age to whom the Lord is currently revealing His will for us.” (*The Teachings of Ezra Taft Benson*, 335)

Further recommended reading:

1. Nancy Jensen, at Gospel Doctrine Plus, in “[Doctrine and Covenants Lesson #42 Continuing Revelation](#)”. Nancy tells the story of Elijah Abel (1810-1884), the first black member of the Church.
2. Monte F. Shelley, “[#42: Continuing Revelation to Prophets](#),” 6 Dec 2009. Monte has some very fine quotes here. Number 8. Decision Making in Church Councils has a marvelous story and quote by Pres. Eyring.
3. Edward L. Kimball, “[Spencer W. Kimball and the Revelation on Priesthood](#),” *BYU Studies*, Volume 47 Number 2. This page includes a brief description of the article and a FREE – PDF Download.